Jude D. Edelman

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Research Statement

My work interrogates the distinct mechanisms that make the top and bottom of the class distribution especially sticky and increasingly polarized, producing little mobility across the life course and between generations. I am currently working on projects that examine the child welfare system and post-secondary educational institutions in the U.S as sites of potential mobility, where structural and discursive factors instead produce durable inequalities for the populations moving through them.

Education

PhD, Sociology 2025–Present
Florida State University

BS, Psychology (with honors) 2025
Florida State University – *Magna Cum Laude*
Honors Thesis: Does Perceived Harm Depend on the Race of the Agent
Mentored by Dr. David March, FSU

BS, Sociology 2025
Florida State University – *Magna Cum Laude*

Research and Teaching Interests

Social Stratification & Mobility · (Critical (Race)) Theory · Education & Labor · Epistemology · Child Welfare · Rural Studies

Works in Progress

Moss-Pech, C.† & **Edelman, J.D.**† "College Skill-use and Employment Experiences Four Years after Graduation." *Manuscript in preparation.*

Edelman, J.D., "Fostering Inequality: How Privatization Policy Has Differential Impact Across Geographic Space." Manuscript in preparation for submission to *Research in Social Stratification and Mobility.*

Edelman, J.D., & Buggs, S. "Conservative and Abolitionist Discourse in U.S. Child Welfare Reform." Data analysis phase.

Edelman, J.D., "The Racial Genealogy of the U.S Foster Care System." Manuscript in preparation for submission to *Critical and Radical Social Work.*

† denotes equal authorship

Selected Presentations

Forthcoming

"Fostering Inequality: How Privatization of the U.S. Foster Care System Impacts Different Groups' Mobility Outcomes," *Association for Interdisciplinary Studies*, Panama City, FL, November 9, 2026.

"Fostering Inequality: How Privatization of the U.S. Foster Care System Impacts Rural and Urban Mobility Outcomes," *Southern Demographic Association*, Austin, TX, October 7, 2026.

Completed

"Fostering Inequality: How Privatization of the U.S. Foster Care System Impacts Rural and Urban Mobility Outcomes," *Annual Meeting of the Rural Sociological Society*, Raleigh, NC, August 1, 2026.

Invited Talks

"Same Shock, Different Story: Race and the Social Construction of Pain," *Howard Baker Research Talk*, FSU Department of Psychology, April 25, 2024.

"How Pain Perception is Moderated by Race of the Aggressor," March Labs, FSU (virtual), March 17, 2024.

Funding and Awards

Sara Miller McCune Scholarship for ICPSR	$5,000
Charles B. Nam Fellowship Fund Travel Award (August 2026)	$1,500
Association for Interdisciplinary Studies Travel Award (November 2026)	$675
College of Graduate Students Travel Grant	$200
Outstanding Graduate Student Service Award, Departmental Award	2026

Applied Service

Community Impact Panelist, Children's Services Council of Leon County 2026
Worked cooperatively to oversee the distribution of a $2.7 million budget to community-based OST programs and presented recommendations to the public and the board.

Wish Upon a Star Volunteer Coordinator, Partnership for Strong Families 2025
Oversaw the distribution of holiday presents to hundreds of children in the child welfare system in North Central Florida.

Professional Activities and Service

Rural Sociological Society, Member	2026–Present
American Sociological Association, Member	2025–Present
Sociology Graduate Student Union, Working Group Organizer	2025–Present
Graduate Assistants Union, Member	2025–Present
Association for Interdisciplinary Studies, Member	2026–Present
Southern Demographic Association, Member	2026–Present

Research Experience

Research Assistant, March Lab – Threat Perception and Cognition 2021–2025
Florida State University, PI: D. March

Research Assistant, Sub-Saharan Africa Maternal Health Lab 2025–Present
Florida State University, PI: K. Davis

Research Assistant, 2026–Present
Florida State University, PI: C. Moss-Pech

Teaching Experience

Teaching Assistant

Sex and Gender (undergraduate, virtual)	Fall 2025, Spring 2026, Summer 2026
Research Methods (undergraduate, virtual)	Fall 2026